

NON-WSQ COURSE • C1382

Version v4.2 • 18 September 2026

Claude Cowork Masterclass

Live Artefacts, connected tools, skills and Projects — for finance teams

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome

- 1 Introductions
- 2 Ground rules
- 3 Course outline
- 4 How today runs

Let's Know Each Other

Take a minute to introduce yourself to the class.

1

Your name and role

Which team you sit in and what you are responsible for.

2

Your reporting work

One report or summary you produce again and again.

3

Your tools

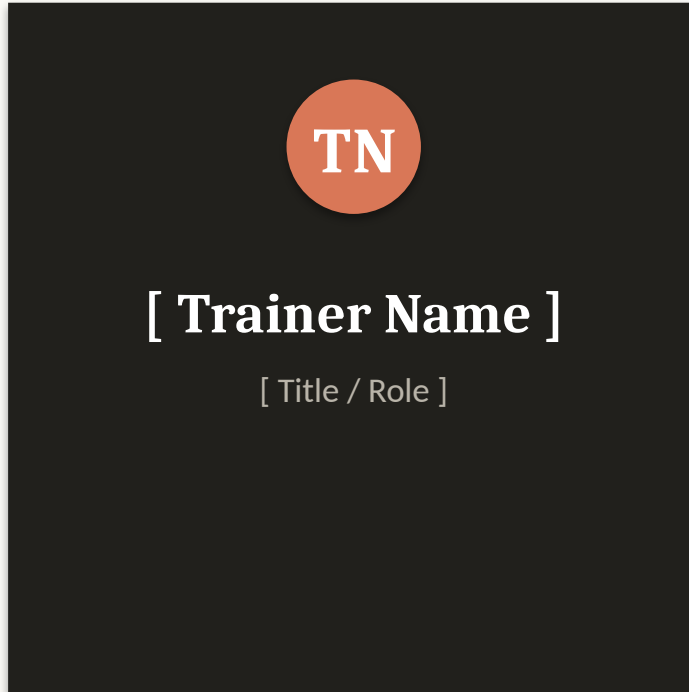
Whether your finance data lives in Excel, Google Drive or a system.

4

Your goal today

What you would most like to stop doing by hand.

About the Trainer



Qualifications: _____



Expertise: _____

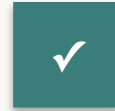
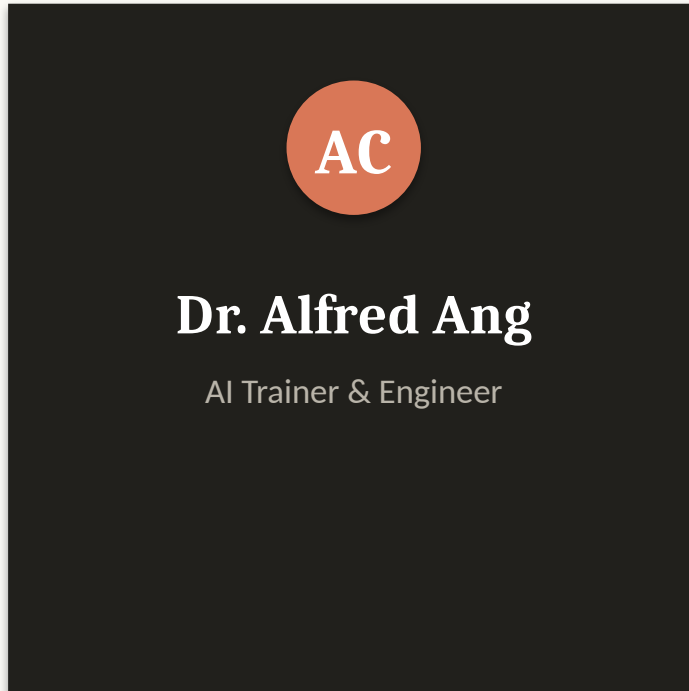


Experience: _____



Contact / Profile: _____

About the Trainer



PhD-qualified trainer specialising in AI, software engineering and developer tooling.



Hands-on experience building agentic AI applications and automations with Claude.



Trains professionals across Singapore on practical, project-based AI skills.



Certifications: PMP, AWS, Microsoft, CompTIA, CKA, CKAD.



linkedin.com/in/angchewhoe



github.com/alfredang

Ground Rules

Phones on silent

Step out quietly if you need to take a call.

Ask as you go

No question is too small — others usually have the same one.

Learn by doing

Every topic ends with a lab you build yourself.

Use the mock data

Never bring real client or personal data into a training exercise.

Check before you send

Approve every draft against the source figures.

Mutual respect

One conversation at a time; agree to disagree.

Course Outline

1

Claude Cowork Fundamentals

- The Claude product family
- Set up Cowork
- Live Artefacts
- Working with documents

2

Tools and Skills

- Connectors: Drive and Gmail
- A built-in skill: the board deck
- Agent Skills and /skill-creator
- Do · Verify · Save

3

Claude Projects and Plugins

- What a Project is
- The four project panels
- Assemble the Meridian workspace
- Skills vs plugins, and installing one

Learning Outcomes

1

Process documents

Set up the Cowork desktop workspace and have Claude process a folder of documents into a structured summary.

3

Connect Drive

Connect the Google Drive connector so Claude can read finance data held outside the chat.

5

Generate the board deck

Generate a board-ready deck with real charts from connected data, using a skill Claude loads on demand.

7

Brand it by command

Capture a documented house style as a reusable skill that brands any presentation on command.

9

Install a plugin

Install a plugin and explain how a packaged bundle of skills differs from a skill you wrote yourself.

2

Build a Live Artefact

Build, save and download a Live Artefact, including an interactive sales dashboard from supplied data.

4

Deliver by Gmail

Refresh a Live Artefact from connected data and send an approved summary with the Gmail connector.

6

Save it as a skill

Turn a verified routine into an Agent Skill with /skill-creator, update it, and explain a skill's three layers.

8

Build the Project

Assemble a Claude Project that holds the data, instructions, skills and dashboard as one reusable team workspace.

Lesson Plan — One Day

9:00am – 6:00pm, with a one-hour lunch and two tea breaks.

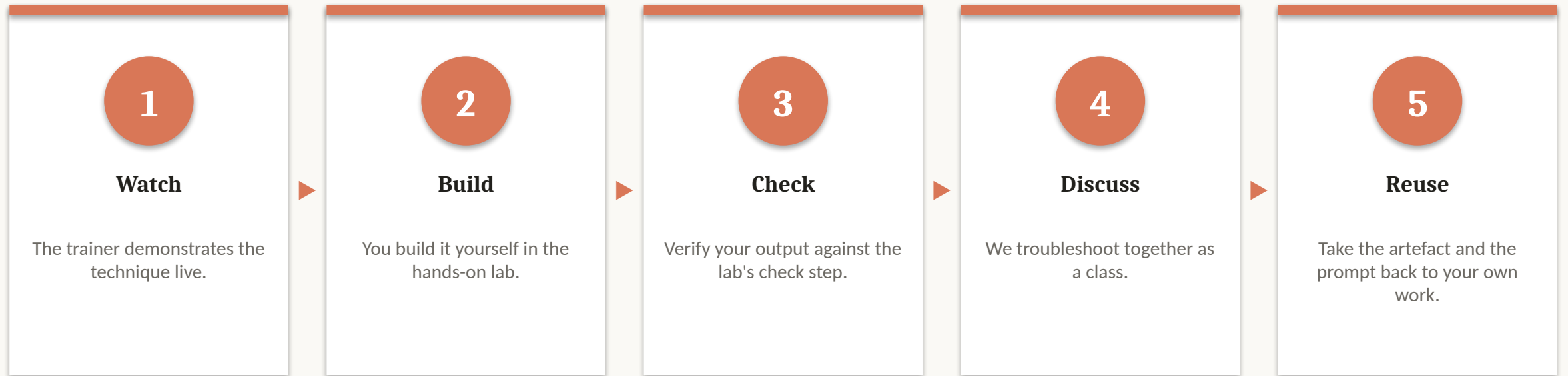
Morning

- 9:00 Welcome
- 9:20 Topic 1 — Claude Cowork Fundamentals
- 9:55 Topic 1 — Live Artefacts
- 10:20 Tea break
- 10:35 Topic 1 — Working with documents
- 10:50 Hands-on: Labs 1, 2
- 12:05 Topic 2 — Tools

Afternoon

- 12:30 Lunch break
- 13:30 Hands-on: Lab 3
- 14:10 Hands-on: Labs 4, 5
- 15:05 Tea break
- 15:20 Topic 2 — Skills
- 15:35 Hands-on: Lab 6
- 16:05 Hands-on: Lab 7
- 16:40 Hands-on: Lab 8
- 17:00 Topic 3 — Claude Projects and Plugins
- 17:10 Hands-on: Lab 9
- 17:35 Hands-on: Lab 10
- 17:50 Recap

How You'll Learn



Ten labs, one continuous scenario — each lab builds on the one before it.

THE SCENARIO

One firm, ten labs

Meridian Capital Partners is a fictitious Singapore-based investment and advisory firm with four revenue desks — Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit and Corporate Finance. All figures, clients, staff and documents in this course are synthetic and used for training only.

TOPIC 01

Claude Cowork Fundamentals

- 1 The Claude product family
- 2 Set up Cowork
- 3 Live Artefacts
- 4 Working with documents

The Claude Product Family

Anthropic offers several Claude products — here's how they differ so you know which is which.



Claude.ai

The chat assistant on web, desktop & mobile for everyday tasks.



Claude Code

Agentic coding tool in your terminal, IDE & desktop.



Claude Cowork

Desktop agent for non-developers to automate files & tasks.



Claude Design

Generates polished UI & frontend designs.



Claude for Microsoft

Claude inside Microsoft 365 & Outlook.



Claude for Chrome

Browser agent that navigates and acts on the web for you.

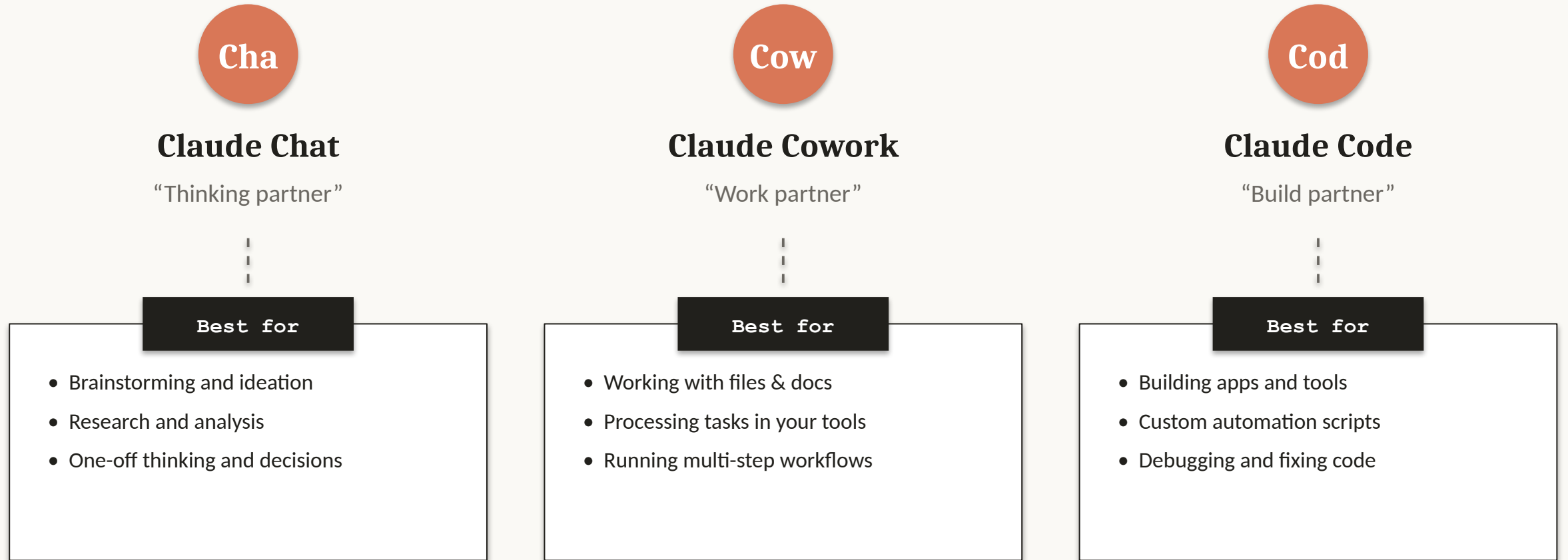


Claude for Science

Speeds up research workflows for scientists and labs.

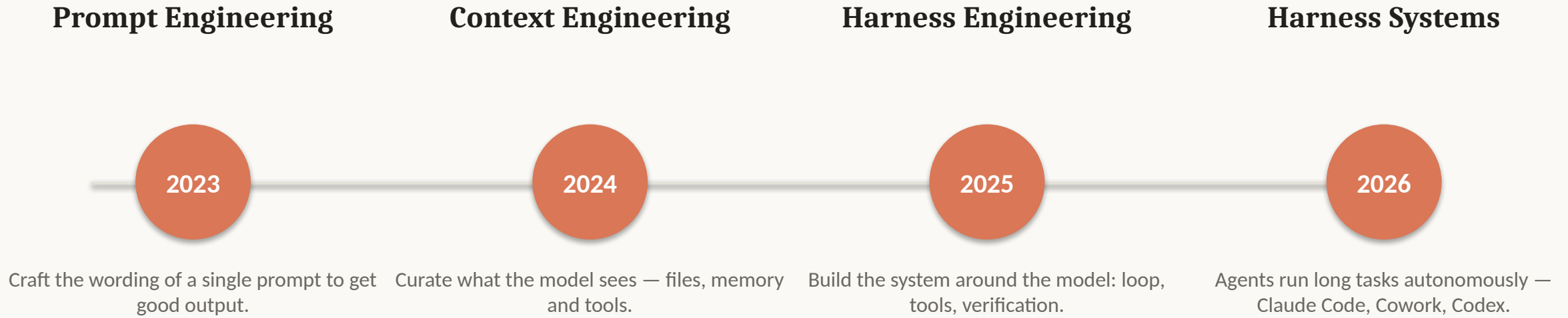
TIP All are powered by the same Claude models — they differ in where they run and who they're for.

Chat, Cowork or Code?



This course is about the middle one — the work partner that acts on your files and tools rather than only answering.

The Evolution of AI Engineering



More capable models shift the work from wording prompts → curating context → engineering the whole harness.

What Makes Cowork So Useful

Five things a chat window cannot do.

1

Access local files

Read, write and reorganise the folders on your computer.

2

Write & run code

It writes the code a task needs and runs it — you never see or edit it.

3

Connect to tools

Reach Google Drive, Gmail and Calendar through connectors.

4

Skills & plugins

Reusable instructions it loads on demand, shareable with your team.

5

Agent loop

Plan, act, check, correct — it keeps working until the task is done.

Claude Pricing

Cowork is a desktop feature of the paid Claude plans — the same subscription that covers Claude Chat and Claude Code.



Pro

\$17/mo (annual) • \$20 monthly.
Cowork included.



Max

From \$100/mo — 5× or 20×
more usage than Pro.



Team

\$20/seat standard • \$100/seat
premium (5× usage).



Enterprise

\$20/seat + usage at API rates.
Contact sales.

API pay-as-you-go (per million tokens, input / output): Opus 4.8 \$5 / \$25 • Sonnet 4.6 \$3 / \$15 • Haiku 4.5 \$1 / \$5

TIP A free plan is also available, but it does not include Cowork. Prices as of June 2026 — verify at claude.com/pricing.

Set Up Claude Cowork

Cowork runs in the Claude desktop app on a paid plan.

1

Install the desktop app

Download Claude for Mac or Windows from claude.ai/download — Live Artefacts and local file access are desktop features.

2

Sign in on a paid plan

Cowork is available on paid plans; sign in with the account that has your subscription.

3

Open Cowork

Choose Cowork in the sidebar to get the agent workspace rather than a plain chat.

4

Point it at a folder

Connect the one folder for the task so Claude reads your files and writes its output back.

5

Enable what it needs

Turn on only the connectors the task needs, from the + menu.

6

Keep the app open

The desktop app must stay open while a task is using your computer.

Key Concepts — Claude Cowork Fundamentals

1

Claude Cowork

The desktop agent that works on your files and tasks — built for non-developers, not coders.

2

Live Artefacts

Interactive tools that persist in your workspace and refresh their data when reopened.

3

Desktop, not browser

Live Artefacts and local file access need the Claude desktop app on a paid plan.

4

Describe, don't code

You describe the tool you want in plain English; Claude writes and runs the code.

5

Save to the sidebar

A saved artefact is reopenable and reusable — it is not lost in the chat history.

6

Download to share

Export the artefact so it can be filed, attached or handed to someone without Claude.

Process a Folder of Invoices

LAB 01

Meridian's accountant needs the 2025 supplier invoices summarised and filed. You point Cowork at a folder of 126 PDFs — a full year of invoices, a few expense receipts, and the untidy filenames a real downloads folder collects — and have it read every document, build one CSV, and sort the files into month folders. This is work no dashboard can do: reading documents and acting on your file system. It is also far more than you would ever do by hand, which is the point.

YOU'LL BUILD

An `invoices_2025.csv` summary plus the PDFs filed into YEAR-MONTH folders.

Tools: Claude Cowork, local files, PDF reading

Extract the invoice data and file the PDFs

PROMPT — copy into Claude

In this folder are all my invoices from 2025. I need you to process these so I can send them to my accountant.

Read each invoice and extract the following data points:

- invoice number
- invoice sender
- invoice sender address
- invoice date
- invoice due date
- total amount due
- currency

NOTE Continues on the next slide.

Extract the invoice data and file the PDFs (cont.)

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Then create a CSV called invoices_2025.csv where you store all this information as well as the filename.

After you have extracted the information, move each invoice PDF into sub folders based on the YEAR-MONTH of the invoice date, using the naming convention 2025-01, 2025-02 and so on.

Flag anything that does not look like a normal supplier invoice, or that you think I should check. Do not delete any file.

NOTE Work on a copy of the folder — tell Claude to move files, never to delete them.

Process a Folder of Invoices

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Open the Claude desktop app, sign in, and choose Cowork in the sidebar.
- 2 Copy the lab's "2025 Invoices" folder somewhere you can work on it.
- 3 Open the folder yourself and skim it before you start — 126 files.
- 4 Start a Cowork session pointed at that folder, then paste the lab prompt.
- 5 Let Claude work through the PDFs — this one takes a few minutes.
- 6 Open invoices_2025.csv and check the row count against the folder.
- 7 Total the SGD column and compare it against S\$777,954.81.
- 8 Check the currency column — four invoices are in US dollars.
- 9 Confirm the PDFs now sit in 2025-01 ... 2025-12 folders and nothing was deleted.
- 10 Read Claude's list of flagged items and decide what to do about each.

Process a Folder of Invoices

✓ Check your work

invoices_2025.csv lists every invoice with all seven fields plus the filename. The 117 SGD invoices total S\$777,954.81; the four USD invoices are marked USD rather than added to that total. The duplicated invoice and the four expense receipts are flagged rather than counted as ordinary invoices. The PDFs now sit in 2025-01 ... 2025-12 folders and all 126 files are still present.

Why a Live Artefact?

The difference between an answer you read and a tool you keep.

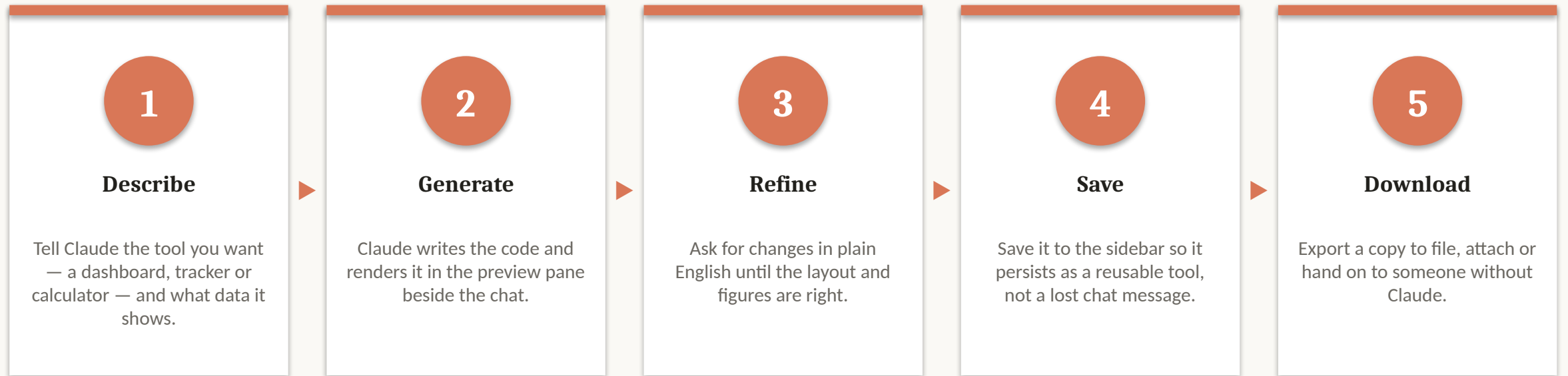
A normal chat answer

- A static snapshot in the conversation.
- Scrolls away as the chat grows.
- Figures are frozen at the moment they were written.
- You copy and paste to reuse anything.
- Nothing to click, filter or explore.

A Live Artefact

- An interactive tool with its own space in the sidebar.
- Reopenable — it stays available after the chat ends.
- Pulls fresh data when you open it.
- Keeps what you typed into it between sessions.
- Clickable: filter, sort and drill into the numbers.

Building a Live Artefact



You describe the outcome in plain English — Claude writes and runs the code.

What an Artefact Can and Cannot Do

Artefacts run in a sandbox, so anything needing the internet has to come in another way.

An artefact **CAN**

- Run interactive code — inputs, filters, charts.
- Use data you gave it, or that Claude looked up while building.
- Keep what you type into it between sessions.
- Be saved, reopened and shared.
- Be downloaded as a file you own.

An artefact **CANNOT**

- Call an external API or website — the sandbox blocks it.
- Load a script, font or image from another site.
- Reach your local files or network.
- Refresh third-party data on its own.
- So: bake the data in, or download the HTML and run it yourself.

Your First Live Artefact

LAB 02

Now you have seen Cowork do a real piece of work, meet the other thing it makes: a Live Artefact. You build a small tool rather than ask a question, so you can see how an artefact differs from a chat answer — it persists, it is interactive, and you can save and download it. You also meet the sandbox: an artefact cannot call the internet, so you build one version with the rates baked in and a downloadable HTML version that fetches them live.

YOU'LL BUILD

An FX converter as a saved artefact, plus a downloadable HTML version with live rates.

Tools: Claude desktop app, Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts

Build your first Live Artefact

PROMPT — copy into Claude

I want a currency converter for Meridian Capital Partners, in three steps. Artefacts cannot call the internet, so do NOT put any fetch, API call or network request in the artefact — it will fail.

STEP 1 — You look up the rates.

Search the web for today's mid-market rates from SGD to USD, EUR and GBP. Tell me the three rates and the date, in the chat.

NOTE Continues on the next slide.

Build your first Live Artefact (cont.)

PROMPT — copy into Claude

STEP 2 — Build the artefact with those numbers HARD-CODED.

Write the three rates into the code as constants. No fetch anywhere.

- Convert between SGD, USD, EUR and GBP.
- One amount box, a from-currency and a to-currency selector, and a large result that updates as I type.
- Under the result show the rate used, and the line "Rates as at <the date from Step 1> — fixed at build time".
- Clean, professional finance styling, titled "Meridian Capital Partners".

STEP 3 — Now a SEPARATE downloadable HTML file.

Save a file called meridian-fx-live.html to my folder. Same design, but this one DOES fetch rates from a free no-key API (such as open.er-api.com or frankfurter.app) when it opens, with a Refresh button and the fetch time shown. Tell me where you saved it.

Do not show this version as an artefact — it only works when I open the file in my own browser.

NOTE The prompt tells Claude NOT to put a fetch in the artefact. If you leave that out, Claude writes one and the artefact shows "Live rate lookup failed" — the sandbox blocks it. Live data belongs in the downloadable HTML, which runs in your own browser.

Your First Live Artefact

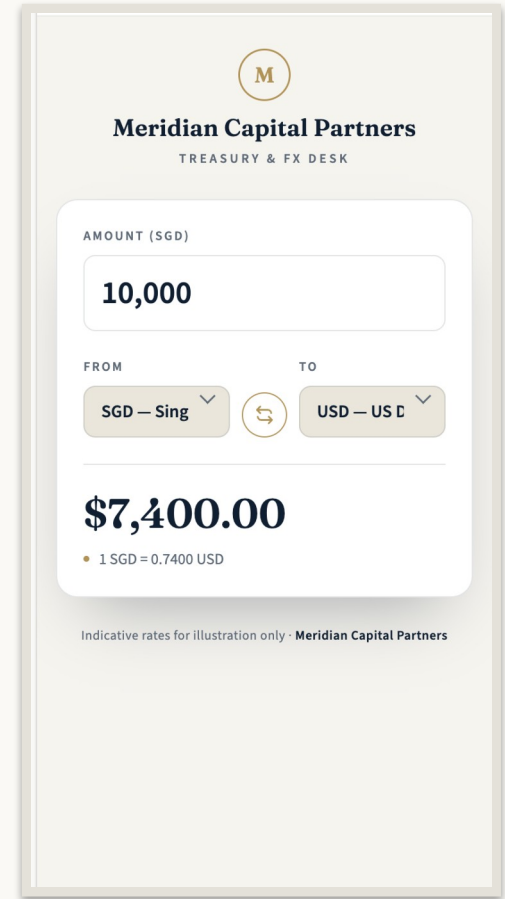
Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Start a new Cowork session — this lab needs no files.
- 2 Paste the lab prompt into the composer and send it.
- 3 Read the three rates Claude reports back in the chat.
- 4 Try the artefact: change the amount and switch the currencies.
- 5 Check the artefact's rate against a search for "1 USD to SGD".
- 6 Open the downloaded meridian-fx-live.html in your browser and click Refresh.
- 7 Ask for one refinement in plain English, for example: Add a thousands separator to the result.
- 8 Save the artefact so it appears in your sidebar.

Your First Live Artefact

✓ Check your work

The artefact converts S\$10,000 to USD with no error, shows the rate used and a "Rates as at ... — fixed at build time" line, and the rate matches a live search. Separately, meridian-fx-live.html opens in your browser, fetches its own rates and updates them when you click Refresh. The artefact is saved in your sidebar.



The screenshot shows a web interface for Meridian Capital Partners, Treasury & FX Desk. It features a currency converter with the following elements:

- Header:** Meridian Capital Partners logo (a circle with 'M') and the text "Meridian Capital Partners" and "TREASURY & FX DESK".
- Form:** A white box containing the converter controls.
 - AMOUNT (SGD):** A text input field with the value "10,000".
 - FROM:** A dropdown menu showing "SGD — Sing" with a downward arrow.
 - TO:** A dropdown menu showing "USD — US D" with a downward arrow.
 - Rate:** A large, bold display of "\$7,400.00".
 - Rate Info:** A small line of text below the rate: "• 1 SGD = 0.7400 USD".
- Footer:** A small line of text at the bottom of the white box: "Indicative rates for illustration only · Meridian Capital Partners".

The finished converter — your rates will differ

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

LAB 03

Meridian's head of finance wants to see how the four revenue desks performed this year without opening a spreadsheet. You take the supplied sales data and build it into a Live Artefact dashboard — KPI tiles, a trend chart and a desk breakdown — then save it. This dashboard is the artefact every later lab builds on.

YOU'LL BUILD

A saved Live Artefact dashboard showing Meridian's FY2025 revenue by desk.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts, local files

Build the Meridian sales dashboard

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the attached meridian-sales-fy2025.csv, build me a Live Artefact:
an interactive sales dashboard for Meridian Capital Partners.

Include:

- KPI tiles: total revenue, total deals, average deal size, best desk.
- A monthly revenue trend chart for the full year.
- A breakdown of revenue by desk (Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit, Corporate Finance).
- A filter to show one desk at a time or all desks.

Format all money as Singapore dollars with thousands separators.

Use a clean, professional finance layout. Title it

"Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Revenue".

NOTE Attach the CSV from your lab's mock-data folder before sending the prompt.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Open the lab folder and look at meridian-sales-fy2025.csv so you know what the data holds.
- 2 Start a Cowork session and attach the CSV, or point Claude at the lab folder.
- 3 Paste the lab prompt and send it.
- 4 Check the KPI tiles against the CSV: total revenue should be S\$24,850,000 across 214 deals.
- 5 Use the desk filter to view Advisory on its own, then return to all desks.
- 6 Refine the layout in plain English, for example: Move the KPI tiles above the chart.
- 7 Save the dashboard to your sidebar with a clear name, then download a copy.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

✓ Check your work

The dashboard shows total revenue S\$24,850,000 and 214 deals, Advisory is the best desk at S\$8,420,000, the desk filter changes the chart, and the artefact reopens from your sidebar after you close it.

Recap — Claude Cowork Fundamentals

1

Lab 01

You can now extract structured data from a folder of PDFs and reorganise the files.

2

Lab 02

You can now set up the Cowork workspace and build, save and download a Live Artefact.

3

Lab 03

You can now turn supplied finance data into an interactive Live Artefact dashboard.

TOPIC 02

Tools and Skills

- 1 Connectors: Drive and Gmail
- 2 A built-in skill: the board deck
- 3 Agent Skills and /skill-creator
- 4 Do · Verify · Save

What Connectors Do

Connectors let Claude reach data and services that live outside the chat.

1

Google Drive

Search and read Sheets, Docs, Slides and PDFs; upload files; create folders; save Claude's output back to Drive.

2

Gmail

Search and read mail, draft messages, send / reply / forward with approval, and manage labels.

3

Google Calendar

View events, find availability, and create or update meetings.

4

Microsoft 365

Reads SharePoint, Outlook, Teams and OneDrive files. Creating or updating files needs write tools an administrator must enable — off by default, which is why Lab 6 has Claude build the deck itself.

5

Approval by default

Claude asks for explicit approval before it sends, replies to or forwards an email.

6

Where to manage them

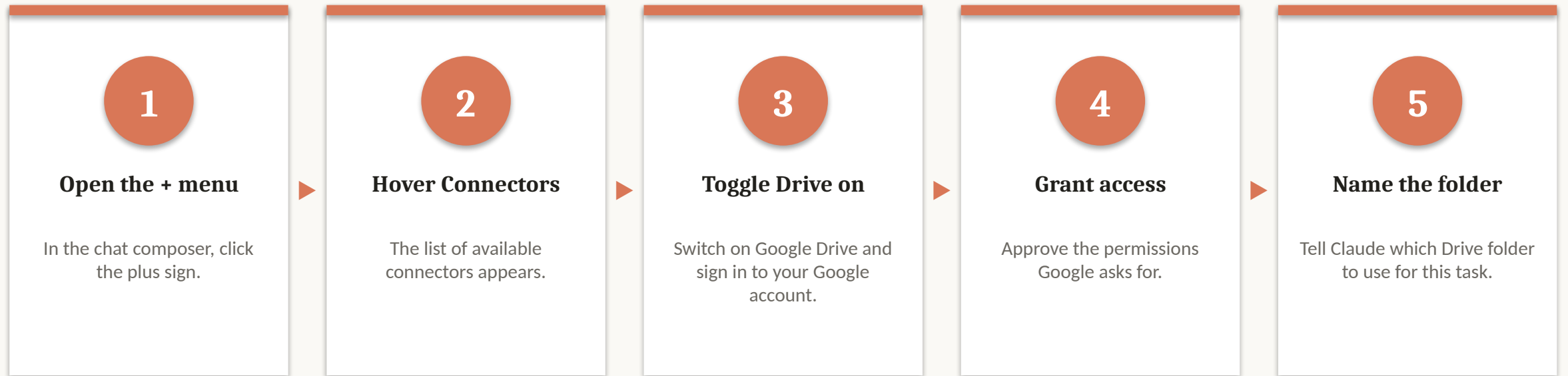
Individually from the + menu; account-wide under Customize → Connectors.

7

Known limits

Attachment contents are not read (metadata only) and images embedded in Docs are not processed.

Turning On a Connector



Manage them any time under Customize → Connectors.

Context Window

“

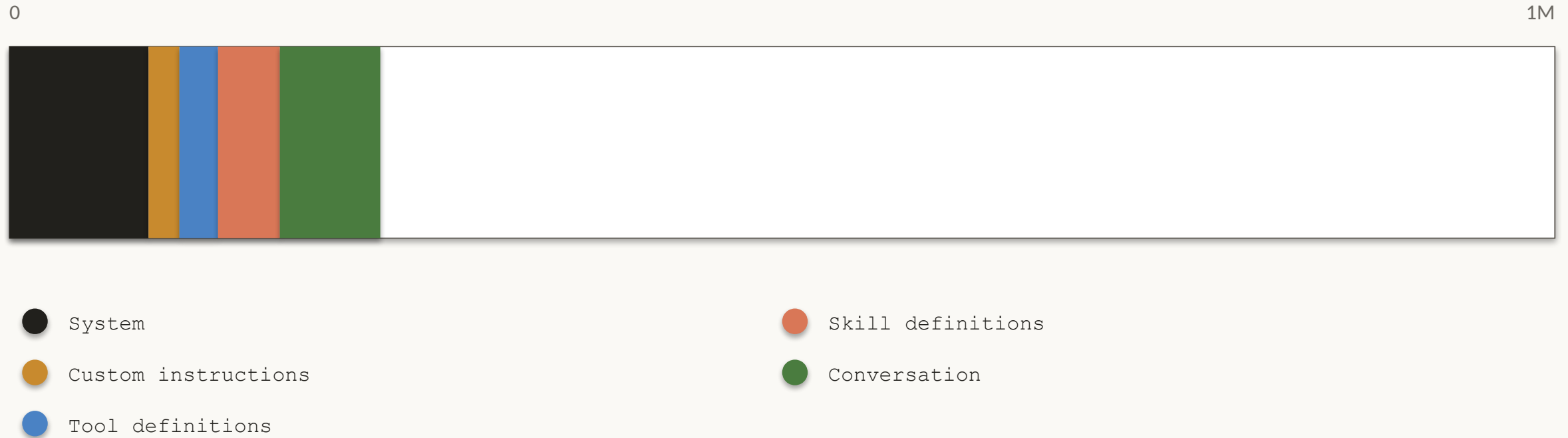
The context window is all the information the model can “see” when producing a response.

”

Files, instructions, tools and skills all have to fit inside it.

What Fills the Context Window

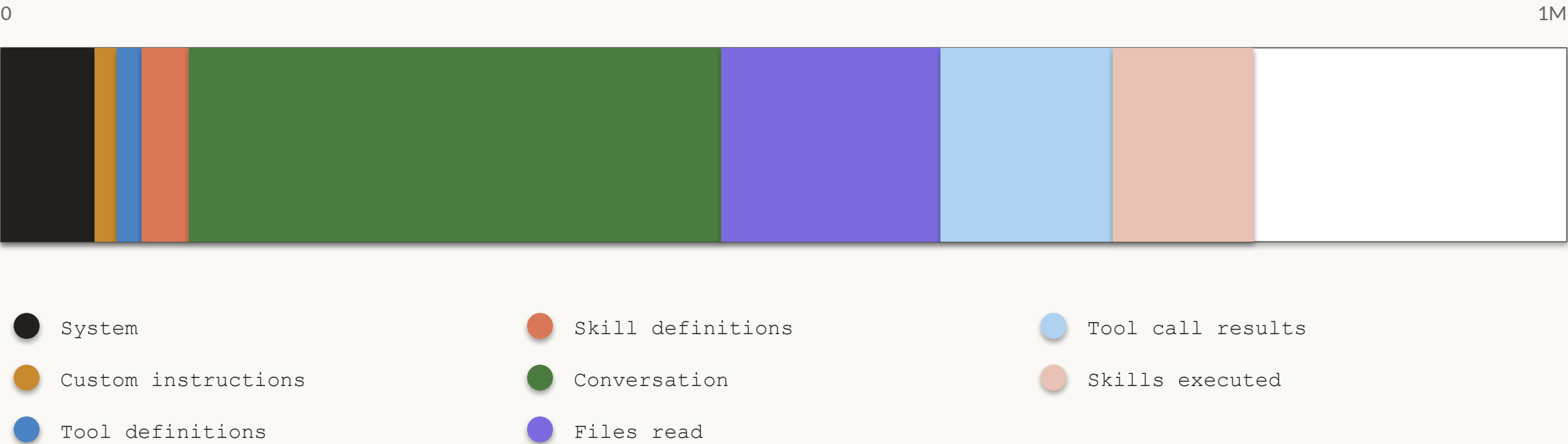
At the start of a session.



At the start of a session only the fixed overhead is loaded — most of the window is still free.

The Same Window, Later in the Session

After reading files, calling tools and running skills.



As the task runs, files, tool results and executed skills all accumulate. Start a fresh session for a new task rather than letting one fill up.

When the Context Window Fills Up

1. Context rot

Performance degrades. Recall of specific facts gets worse, the model starts confusing similar entities, and reasoning quality drops.

2. Tool confusion

Claude sees every tool definition. The more options competing for its attention, the more likely it picks the wrong one or fills in the wrong parameters.

3. Slower responses

The model processes every token on every turn. A bigger context means more work per message, which means longer waits before you see a reply.

4. Eats up your usage faster

Your entire context gets resent with each new message — so more tokens are burned per turn, and your limits are reached sooner.

The fix is housekeeping: one task per session, only the connectors you need, and only the files the task actually reads.

Five Levers of Context

What you actually control.

1

Conversation

Your prompt. The messages you send, including both text and attachments.

2

Working folder

The files and folders Claude can access while working on the task.

3

Connectors

The connected tools Claude can pull data from, and take actions in.

4

Skills

A set of instructions Claude follows for a repeatable workflow.

5

Instructions

Saved instructions at the folder level, which Claude always reads first.

Every lab today pulls one of these levers — the working folder in Lab 1, connectors in Labs 4–5, skills in Labs 6–8, and project instructions in Lab 9.

Check It Yourself: /context

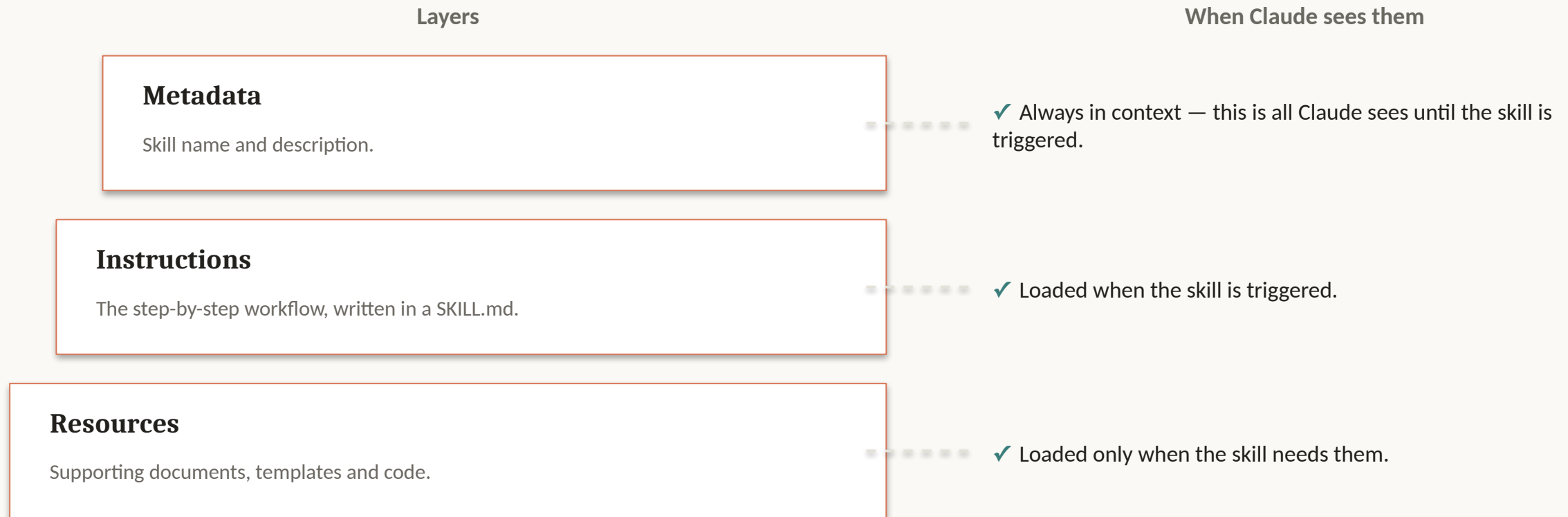
Estimated usage by category, for a 1M-token window.

Category	Tokens	Percentage
System prompt	35.3k	3.5%
System tools	768	0.1%
MCP tools	2.6k	0.3%
MCP tools (deferred)	301.7k	30.2%
Memory files	81	0.0%
Skills	9k	0.9%
Messages	13	0.0%
Free space	650.5k	65.0%

Run /context to see this for your own session. Note how much a large set of connectors costs before you have typed anything — turn off the ones you do not need.

Skills Are Documented on Three Layers

Each layer reaches Claude at a different moment — which is why the description matters most.



Anatomy of an Agent Skill

A skill is a folder Claude loads on demand when the task matches its description.

1

Metadata — name

A short identifier such as daily-brief. This is what you type to run it.

2

Metadata — description

What the skill does and WHEN to use it. Always in context, so this is what Claude matches against your request.

3

Instructions (SKILL.md)

The routine itself: which tools to check, in what order, and what to report.

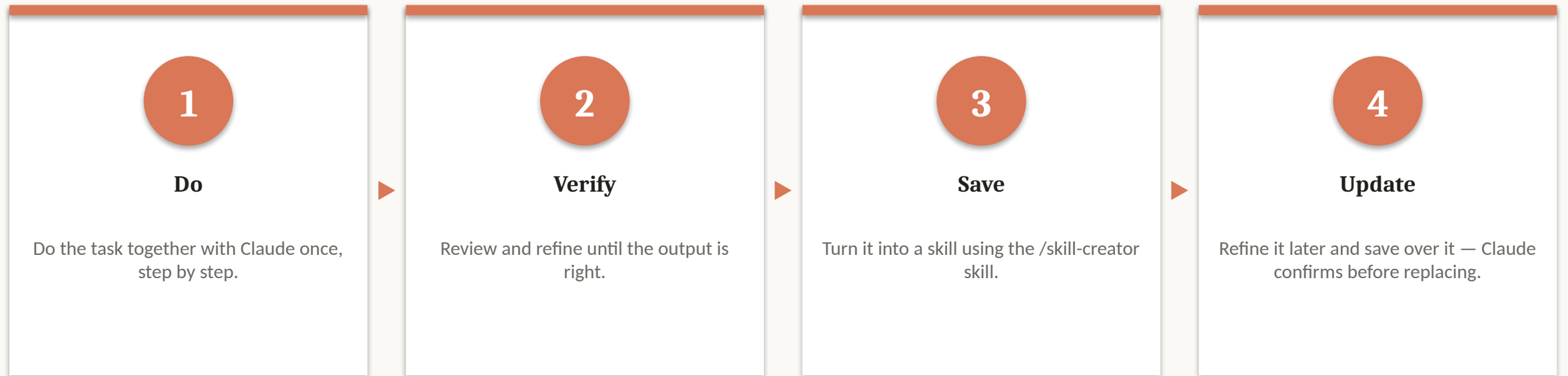
4

Resources

Optional templates, documents or code the instructions call on.

Creating Your Own Skill

Do not write a skill from a blank page — do the work first, then capture it.



`/skill-creator` writes the `SKILL.md` for you, from the run you just verified.

A Skill vs Retyping the Request

Write the routine once, and run it by name from then on.

Retyping the request each time

- You describe the whole routine again every morning.
- Easy to forget a step when you are in a hurry.
- Each colleague words it slightly differently.
- The output format drifts from day to day.
- Nothing to hand to a new joiner.

An Agent Skill

- Written once in SKILL.md and run by name.
- Claude follows every step, every time.
- The whole team shares one folder.
- The same structure and format each run.
- Onboarding is: copy the skill folder.

A Skill That Drives Your Tools

The most useful skills combine the connectors into one repeatable command.

1

One command

Run the whole routine by name instead of describing it again each time.

2

Across your tools

The skill decides which connectors to check — Drive, Gmail, Calendar — and in what order.

3

A fixed structure

It reports back in the same sections every run, so you can scan it in seconds.

4

With fallbacks

When a source has nothing new, it says so plainly rather than inventing filler.

5

Still under approval

The skill drafts and reports; sending anything still needs your approval.

6

Shared with the team

Everyone runs the same routine and gets the same briefing format.

Key Concepts — Tools and Skills

1

Connectors

Toggle Gmail, Calendar and Drive on from the + menu so Claude can reach data outside the chat.

3

Scope the folder

Point Claude at one Drive folder for the task — not your whole Drive.

5

Agent Skills

A folder of instructions Claude loads on demand, so a task runs the same way every time.

7

Where to see them

Your own skills appear in + → Skills. Built-in ones do not — look in the Context panel.

9

/skill-creator

Do the task once, verify the output, then let skill-creator write the SKILL.md for you.

11

Skills use tools

A skill can drive the connectors for you — one command that checks Drive and Gmail and reports back.

2

Google Drive

Claude reads Sheets, Docs, Slides and PDFs from Drive, and can upload files back to a folder.

4

Gmail

Claude drafts, sends, replies and labels — sending asks for explicit approval by default.

6

Built-in skills

Some ship with Claude — pptx builds PowerPoint files. It loads when your request matches.

8

Three layers

Metadata is always in context; the SKILL.md loads when triggered; resources load only when needed.

10

Skills evolve

Update a skill as you learn what you want — saving over it replaces the old version, so re-run to confirm.

Connect Google Drive

LAB 04

Meridian's finance data does not live on your laptop — it sits in a shared Google Drive folder. You upload the firm's wider finance files to Drive, enable the Google Drive connector, and confirm Claude can read them without you attaching anything by hand.

YOU'LL BUILD

A working Google Drive connection scoped to the Meridian finance folder.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Google Drive connector

Read the Meridian finance data from Drive

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the Google Drive connector, open the folder "Meridian Finance" in my Drive and tell me what you find.

For each file, give me:

- The file name and what kind of data it holds.
- The period it covers.
- The three figures you would use in a quarterly revenue summary.

Do not change, move or delete anything — read only.

List anything that looks inconsistent between the files.

NOTE Claude asks for approval before it moves, shares or deletes a Drive file.

Connect Google Drive

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Upload the lab's mock-data files to a new Google Drive folder named Meridian Finance.
- 2 In Claude, click the plus sign in the composer and hover over Connectors.
- 3 Toggle Google Drive on and sign in to your Google account.
- 4 Approve the permissions Google asks for — grant FULL READ access.
- 5 If Claude reports an "insufficient scope" error, reconnect the connector.
- 6 Paste the lab prompt so Claude reads the Meridian Finance folder.
- 7 Compare Claude's file summary against what you actually uploaded.
- 8 Note any inconsistency Claude reports between the files.

Connect Google Drive

✓ Check your work

Claude lists all three Meridian Finance files with their periods, reports FY2025 revenue of S\$24,850,000, and flags that the Q4 Advisory target disagrees between the two files — S\$2,320,000 in the targets file against S\$2,410,000 in the workbook. Nothing in Drive has been changed.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

LAB 05

Quarter end has arrived. You refresh the dashboard you built in Lab 3 using the data Claude now reads from Drive, then have it draft a quarterly summary email to the head of finance. You read the draft against the figures and approve it before a single message leaves your outbox.

YOU'LL BUILD

An updated dashboard plus an approved quarterly summary email sent to yourself.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts, Google Drive connector, Gmail connector

Refresh the dashboard, then draft the summary

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Two tasks, in order.

1. Open my saved "Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Revenue" dashboard and update it from the Meridian Finance folder in Google Drive. Add a Q4 column to the desk breakdown and show each desk's actual against its target.
2. Then draft an email to <YOUR OWN ADDRESS> with the subject "Meridian FY2025 — Q4 revenue summary". In the body:
 - Total FY2025 revenue and the Q4 figure.
 - Each desk's Q4 actual against target, best and worst first.
 - Two sentences explaining the largest variance.
 - A closing line noting the Q4 Advisory target discrepancy.

Show me the draft. Do not send it until I approve it.

NOTE Replace <YOUR OWN ADDRESS> with your own email — never a real client's.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Reopen the dashboard you saved in Lab 3 from your sidebar.
- 2 Enable the Gmail connector from the plus menu, alongside Google Drive.
- 3 Paste the lab prompt, replacing the placeholder with your own email address.
- 4 Watch Claude refresh the dashboard from Drive and add the Q4 target comparison.
- 5 Check the refreshed dashboard: Q4 revenue should be S\$6,980,000 across the four desks.
- 6 Read the drafted email in full and compare every figure against the dashboard.
- 7 Approve the send, then confirm the message arrived in your own inbox.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

✓ Check your work

The dashboard shows a Q4 column with actual against target per desk and Q4 revenue of S\$6,980,000. The email arrives in your own inbox with the correct totals and a closing note about the Advisory target discrepancy.

Generate the Meridian Board Deck

LAB 06

The quarterly board pack is due. In Lab 5 you sent the head of finance a summary email — the board wants the same story as slides. Rather than building it by hand, you have Claude read the Meridian data from Drive and produce the PowerPoint itself.

This is your first look at a skill doing the work. You do not write anything or turn anything on: Claude has a built-in

YOU'LL BUILD

A board-ready PowerPoint with charts and Q4 recommendations, built by Claude's built-in pptx skill.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Google Drive connector, the built-in pptx skill

Generate the Meridian board deck

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the Meridian Finance folder in Google Drive, build me a PowerPoint called "Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Board Review".

Slides:

1. Title slide with the company name and "FY2025 Board Review".
2. FY2025 summary — total revenue, total deals, average deal size and the best-performing desk.
3. Revenue by desk — a bar chart of FY2025 revenue for the four desks, with the figures labelled.
4. Q4 desk performance — a grouped bar chart of each desk's Q4 actual against its target, plus a line on what the gaps mean.
5. Recommendation — how to close the Q4 Advisory shortfall.
6. Recommendation — where to invest next year, based on the strongest and weakest desks.

NOTE Continues on the next slide.

Generate the Meridian board deck (cont.)

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Use real PowerPoint charts, not pictures of charts, so the numbers stay editable. All money in Singapore dollars with thousands separators.

Show me the outline before you build it. When the deck is ready, post the .pptx in the chat so I can download it.

NOTE Ask for the outline first. It is far cheaper to fix the structure before the slides exist than after.

Generate the Meridian Board Deck

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Make sure the Google Drive connector from Lab 4 is still enabled.
- 2 Paste the lab prompt.
- 3 Read the outline Claude proposes and correct it before it builds.
- 4 Open the Context panel in the sidebar and find pptx under Skills.
- 5 Let Claude generate the .pptx and download it.
- 6 Open the PowerPoint and read it end to end.
- 7 Click a chart and confirm it is a real PowerPoint chart.
- 8 Check every figure against the Lab 3 dashboard and the Lab 5 email.
- 9 Confirm the Advisory recommendation names the target discrepancy rather than averaging it away.

Generate the Meridian Board Deck

✓ Check your work

The PowerPoint downloads and opens with six slides. FY2025 revenue reads S\$24,850,000 across 214 deals, Advisory is the best desk at S\$8,420,000, and Q4 totals S\$6,980,000 with each desk shown against its target. The revenue-by-desk and Q4-against-target charts are real PowerPoint charts with editable data, not images. One recommendation slide states the S\$90,000 Q4 Advisory target discrepancy explicitly.

Build a /daily-brief Skill

LAB 07

Labs 4 and 5 showed what the connectors can do, and Lab 6 showed a built-in skill doing the work for you. Now you write one yourself. The reliable way to build a skill is the Do / Verify / Save pattern: do the task with Claude once, refine until the output is right, then use /skill-creator to save it. You have already done the doing — this lab turns it into a command, then updates it. Finally you schedule it, so the briefing is waiting as a draft before you sit down rather than something you have to remember to ask for.

YOU'LL BUILD

A daily-brief Agent Skill you can run by name each morning, updated once and scheduled to run itself at 9am.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Agent Skills, /skill-creator, Google Drive connector, Gmail connector, Scheduled tasks

Block 1 — D0

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Run my morning finance briefing for Meridian Capital Partners, once, so we can get the format right together:

- What changed in the Meridian Finance folder on Google Drive since yesterday?
- Which desks are behind their quarterly target right now?
- What finance emails do I need to respond to today?

If a section has nothing in it, say so plainly — "No new files since yesterday" — rather than padding it out. End with one line on what most needs my attention, or "Nothing urgent — have a good day" if there is nothing. All money in Singapore dollars. Draft only — never send email.

NOTE Stop here. Read the briefing and refine the format before you save anything.

Block 2 — SAVE

PROMPT — copy into Claude

/skill-creator Save the morning finance briefing routine we just ran as a skill called daily-brief. Keep the three sections in the order we settled on, the plain fallback wording for empty sections, the single closing attention line, all money in Singapore dollars, and draft-only — never send email.

NOTE /skill-creator is a slash command YOU type into the composer — not prose inside a longer prompt.

Block 3 — SCHEDULE

INSTRUCTIONS — paste into the scheduled task dialog

Run my daily-brief skill for Meridian Capital Partners.

Leave the briefing as a draft email to me in Gmail, with the subject "Meridian daily brief" and today's date. Do not send it.

If a section has nothing in it, keep the plain fallback wording rather than padding it out.

NOTE This one does not go in the chat — it is the scheduled task's own Instructions field.

Build a /daily-brief Skill

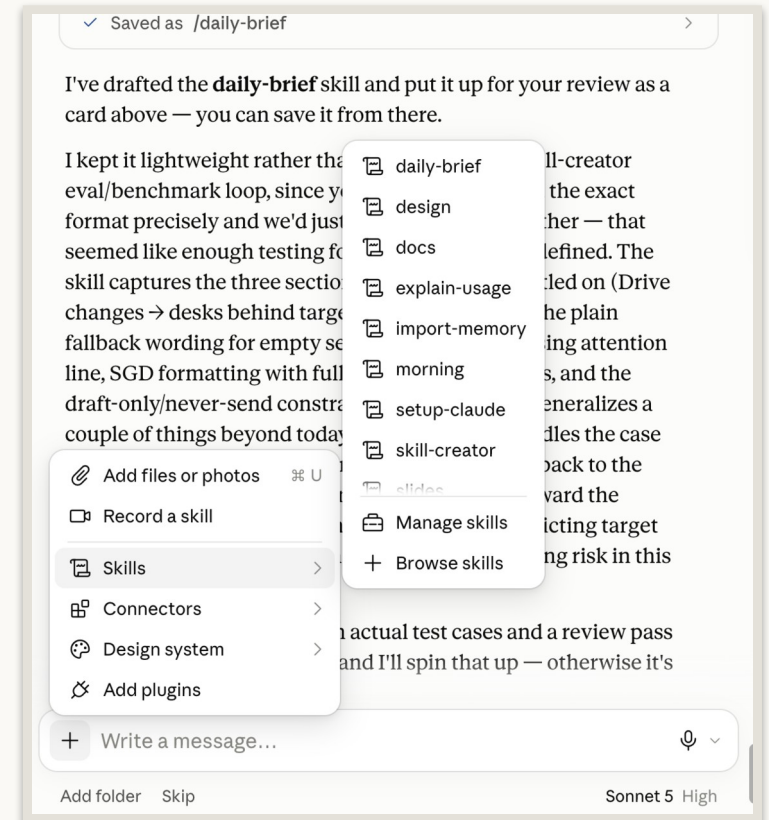
Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Make sure the Drive and Gmail connectors from Labs 4 and 5 are still enabled.
- 2 DO — send block 1 on its own and let Claude run the routine once.
- 3 VERIFY — read the briefing and ask for changes until the format is right.
- 4 Check the fallback wording on any empty section.
- 5 Confirm it drafted and did not send anything.
- 6 SAVE — type /skill-creator in the composer, then send block 2.
- 7 Read the SKILL.md it produces, especially the description line.
- 8 Run the skill by typing /daily-brief, then run it again.
- 9 UPDATE — ask for one change, such as putting the emails section first.
- 10 Save the change under the same skill name and confirm the replace prompt.
- 11 Run /daily-brief once more to confirm the change took effect.
- 12 SCHEDULE — Scheduled tasks → New task → Set up manually, named "Daily briefing".
- 13 Paste Block 3 into Instructions; set Frequency to daily at 9:00am.
- 14 Read Permissions: the task auto-approves, which is why the skill drafts only.
- 15 Decide whether "Require this computer" should be on.
- 16 Run the task once manually, then check Gmail for the draft and an empty Sent folder.

Build a /daily-brief Skill

✓ Check your work

Running /daily-brief produces a briefing with all three sections — Drive changes, desks behind target, emails needing a reply — using the plain fallback wording where a section is empty, ending with a single attention line, with all money in SGD and no email sent. After the update, the revised section order appears on the next run — and Claude warned you before replacing the existing skill. A scheduled task named "Daily briefing" exists, set to run daily at 9:00am, and running it manually leaves a Gmail draft titled "Meridian daily brief" with today's date, while your Sent folder stays empty.



Saved — and now listed under + → Skills

Brand the Board Deck

LAB 08

The board deck from Lab 6 has the right numbers and the wrong clothes — it looks like a default template. Meridian has a branded template every deck is supposed to follow; the problem is that applying it by hand, every time, is what nobody does.

So you do not describe the house style to Claude — you hand it the template and let it work the style out for

YOU'LL BUILD

A brand-deck Agent Skill that applies the Meridian house style to any presentation.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Agent Skills, /skill-creator

Block 1 — D0

PROMPT — copy into Claude

I have attached two files.

The first, meridian-brand-template.pptx, is our house template. Study it and work out the style it uses: the colours, the fonts for headings and body text, how the title slide is treated, the rule under each slide title, and what goes in the footer.

The second is the "Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Board Review" deck I built in the last lab. Apply the template's style to it so the two look like the work of the same firm.

Tell me what style rules you took from the template before you apply them, so I can check you read it correctly.

This is a restyle only — do not change any figure or any wording. Give me the restyled .pptx to download when you are done.

NOTE Ask Claude to state the style rules it read off the template BEFORE it applies them.

Block 2 — SAVE

PROMPT — copy into Claude

/skill-creator Save what we just did as a skill called brand-deck that applies the Meridian house style to any presentation. Write the actual colours, fonts, title treatment and footer you took from the template into the skill, so it works on a deck later without me attaching the template again. Never change figures or wording — restyle only.

NOTE /skill-creator is a slash command YOU type into the composer — not prose inside a longer prompt.

Brand the Board Deck

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Attach the template from mock-data/ and the PowerPoint you downloaded in Lab 6.
- 2 DO — send block 1 on its own and let Claude study the template.
- 3 Read the style rules Claude says it took from the template before it applies them.
- 4 Open the restyled deck beside the template and compare the title slides.
- 5 Check a content slide against the template's content slide.
- 6 Confirm no figure and no wording changed.
- 7 VERIFY — ask for changes until the look is right.
- 8 SAVE — type /skill-creator in the composer, then send block 2.
- 9 Read the SKILL.md it produces and check it recorded the actual style values.
- 10 Attach another deck, type /brand-deck, and run it — without attaching the template.

Brand the Board Deck

✓ Check your work

The restyled deck downloads and matches the template's look — the same background colours, heading and body typefaces, title treatment, rule under each title and footer lockup with the internal-use line and slide number. Every FY2025 and Q4 figure is unchanged from Lab 6, including the S\$90,000 Advisory discrepancy. Running /brand-deck on a different presentation, with no template attached, applies the same house style.

Recap — Tools and Skills

1

Lab 04

You can now enable the Google Drive connector and read finance data held outside the chat.

2

Lab 05

You can now update the Live Artefact from connected data and deliver an approved summary by Gmail.

3

Lab 06

You can now have Claude build a board-ready deck with real charts using a skill it loads on demand.

4

Lab 07

You can now turn a routine you have already done into a reusable Agent Skill, update it, and schedule it to run itself.

5

Lab 08

You can now teach Claude a house style from an example deck and save it as a reusable skill.

TOPIC 03

Claude Projects and Plugins

- 1 What a Project is
- 2 The four project panels
- 3 Assemble the Meridian workspace
- 4 Skills vs plugins, and installing one

Why a Project?

A dedicated place for ongoing work, where context builds over time.

Working in one-off chats

- You re-attach the same files every session.
- Rules are restated from memory each time.
- Your artefacts are scattered across conversations.
- A colleague has to be told how you set it up.
- Knowledge leaves when you do.

Working in a Claude Project

- Files are added once as project knowledge.
- Custom instructions apply to every chat.
- Artefacts and skills live in one workspace.
- A colleague opens the project and is ready.
- The setup outlives any single conversation.

Ways to Start a Project

In Cowork, the files and instructions stay in a folder on your computer.

1

Start from scratch

Create a new project and let Claude set up the folder for it.

2

Bring one over from Chat

Recreate a project you already run in Claude Chat.

3

Use an existing folder

Point the project at a folder you already work from.

Creating a Project, Field by Field

Starting a new project opens the Create a project dialog.

1

What are you working on?

The project's name, e.g. Meridian Finance Reporting. This is how you find it in the sidebar.

2

What are you trying to achieve?

The goal in a few lines — who you are, what you produce, and in what style. Every chat inherits it.

3

Use a folder

Point the project at a folder on your computer, so the files and instructions are yours to open.

Then click Create project. The full standing instructions and the project's files are added afterwards, once the project exists.

What Goes in the Project

The project page has four panels — plus the skills and artefacts you bring with you.

1

Instructions

The standing rules for this work: house style, SGD formatting, check before sending.

2

Context

Documents Claude READS and never edits — brand guidelines, the reporting calendar, desk profiles.

3

Folder

A real folder on your computer where Claude WORKS: it reads the data there and writes its output back.

4

Scheduled

Recurring tasks that belong to this project, such as the 9am daily brief.

5

Your skills

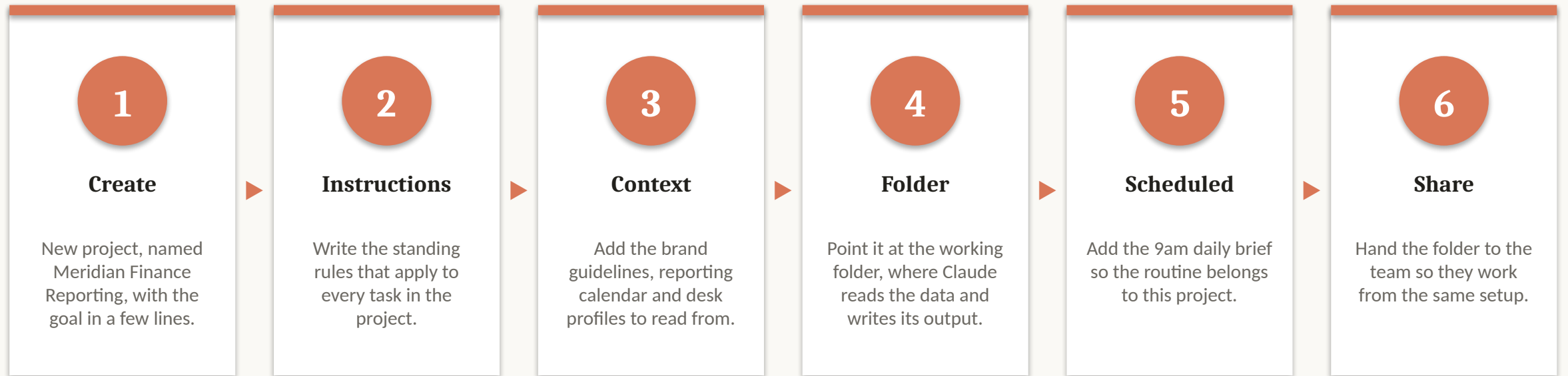
The daily-brief and brand-deck routines, available to everyone working in the project.

6

Your artefacts

The FY2025 dashboard, saved where the team looks for it.

Assembling the Meridian Project



Everything from Labs 1–8, gathered into one workspace you can hand to the team.

Key Concepts — Claude Projects and Plugins

1

A Claude Project

A dedicated place for ongoing work, where context builds over time instead of resetting each chat.

2

Backed by a folder

In Cowork the files and instructions live in a real folder on your computer — you can still open them yourself.

3

Ways to start

Create a new one from scratch, recreate one you run in Chat, or point it at a folder you already work from.

4

Project instructions

Standing rules for this body of work — house style, SGD formatting, check before sending.

5

Context vs Folder

Context is what Claude reads and never edits. Folder is where it actually works — reading data and writing output.

6

Everything in one place

The finance data, the brand rules, your daily-brief and brand-deck skills and the dashboard, together.

7

Share the folder

A colleague opens the same project and inherits the data, rules and tools you set up.

8

Plugins

A bundle somebody else packaged — several skills plus the tools they need, installed in one click from Discover.

9

Namespaced commands

A plugin's commands carry its name: /productivity:start. That prefix is how you tell a bundle's command from one you wrote.

Build the Meridian Claude Project

LAB 09

Everything you have built so far lives in separate places — a dashboard in your sidebar, files in Drive, two skills, a scheduled task, and rules you have been restating by hand. In this final lab you gather them into one Cowork Project: a dedicated folder on your computer where context builds over time, and which a colleague can open and be immediately productive in.

YOU'LL BUILD

A Meridian Finance Reporting project holding the data, instructions, skills and dashboard.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Projects, Agent Skills, Live Artefacts, Google Drive connector

Block 1 — CREATE

GOAL — paste into the Create a project dialog

Quarterly finance reporting for Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd — a Singapore investment firm with four desks: Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit and Corporate Finance. I produce revenue dashboards, board decks and a daily briefing from the firm's finance data, all in Singapore dollars and in the Meridian house style.

NOTE Goes in the "What are you trying to achieve?" box as you create the project.

Block 2 — INSTRUCTIONS

PROMPT — copy into Claude

This project is Meridian Finance Reporting. Write the project instructions that should apply to every task I run in here:

- We are the finance team at Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd. Our four revenue desks are Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit and Corporate Finance.
- All money in Singapore dollars, thousands separators, no decimals.
- Variances show both the absolute figure and the percentage.
- Every report carries the title "Meridian Capital Partners" and the reporting period, and the footer "internal use only".
- Headings in a serif font, body text in a clean sans-serif.
- Tone: factual and concise. No marketing language.
- Always show me a draft before sending anything. Never send email without my explicit approval.
- The finance data in this project folder is the source of truth.

Write these as clear project instructions, then confirm what you will now do differently in every chat in this project.

NOTE Set after the project exists — these rules then apply to every chat in it.

Build the Meridian Claude Project

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

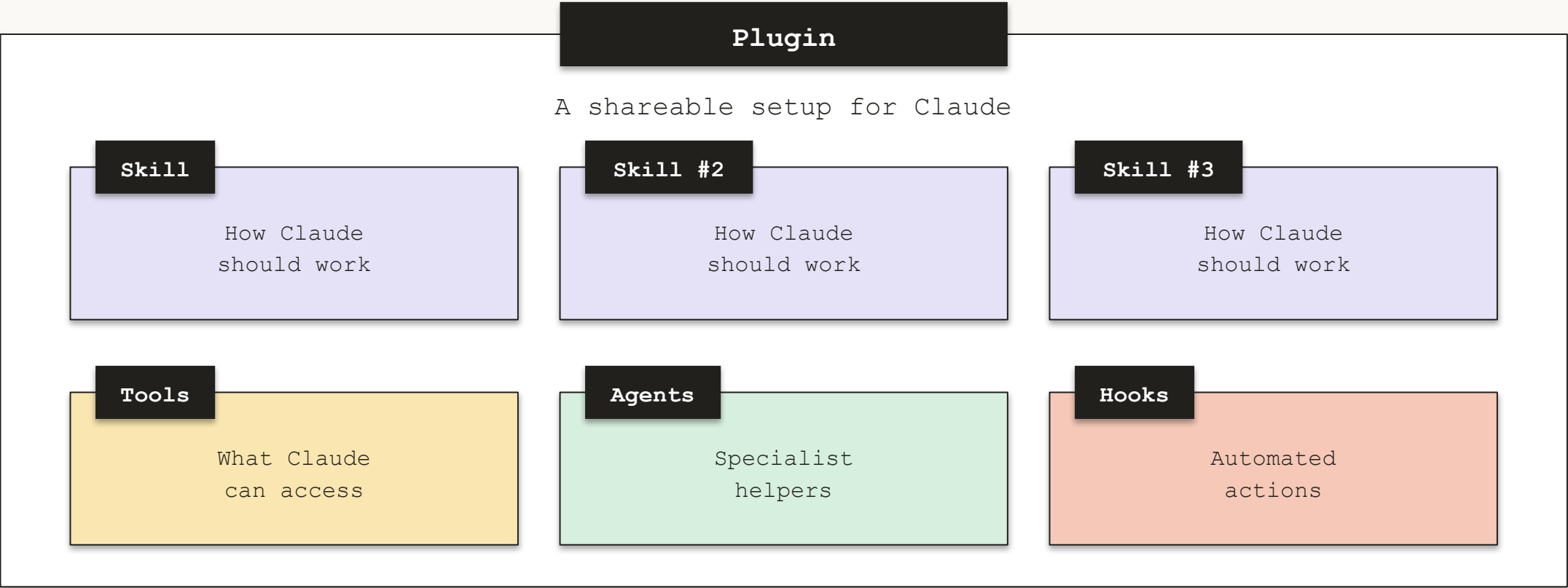
- 1 In Cowork, start a new project to open the Create a project dialog.
- 2 Under "What are you working on?", enter: Meridian Finance Reporting.
- 3 Under "What are you trying to achieve?", paste Block 1.
- 4 Click Create project.
- 5 INSTRUCTIONS — open the panel and set the standing rules with Block 2.
- 6 CONTEXT — add the brand guidelines, the reporting calendar and the desk profiles.
- 7 FOLDER — point the panel at the working/ folder from this lab's mock data.
- 8 SCHEDULED — add the 9am daily-brief task you built in Lab 7 to the project.
- 9 Add the daily-brief skill from Lab 7 and the brand-deck skill from Lab 8 to the project.
- 10 Open the project folder on your computer and confirm the files are really there.
- 11 Save the FY2025 dashboard into the project so it sits with the data it reports on.
- 12 Start a fresh chat in the project and ask for a one-paragraph Q4 summary.
- 13 Confirm all four panels are populated and the folder is ready to share.

Build the Meridian Claude Project

✓ Check your work

A Meridian Finance Reporting project exists with all four panels populated: Instructions carries the house rules, Context holds the brand guidelines, reporting calendar and desk profiles, Folder points at the working folder with the FY2025 revenue data, and Scheduled carries the 9am daily-brief task. Both the daily-brief and brand-deck skills are available and the dashboard is saved. A brand-new chat in the project produces a Q4 summary in SGD with the correct header and footer without you attaching a file or restating a single rule.

Skills vs. Plugins



A skill is one routine. A plugin is the whole setup — hand a colleague the plugin and they get every skill, tool and agent it contains.

Add the Productivity Plugin

LAB 10

Lab 9 packaged your own setup so a colleague could open it and be productive. This lab runs the same idea in the opposite direction: you install a toolkit somebody else packaged.

That is the difference between a skill and a plugin. A skill is one routine you wrote — `/daily-brief` in Lab 7, `/brand-deck` in Lab 8. A plugin is the whole setup: several skills plus the tools they need, installed together in one click.

YOU'LL BUILD

The Productivity plugin installed, with a `TASKS.md` tracking your Meridian follow-ups.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Plugins, the Productivity plugin

Start the productivity toolkit

COMMAND — type into the composer

```
/productivity:start
```

NOTE This lab has no long prompt to paste — it is driven by the plugin's own commands. Note the productivity: prefix: that is how you tell a plugin's command from a skill you wrote.

Add the Productivity Plugin

Full step-by-step, with the reasoning for each step, is in your Learner Guide.

- 1 Open the Plugins panel and switch to the Discover tab.
- 2 Find the Productivity plugin from Anthropic and click Add.
- 3 Check Your plugins to confirm it installed.
- 4 Type / in the composer and find the new /productivity: commands.
- 5 Open the Meridian project from Lab 9 and run /productivity:start there.
- 6 Answer whatever it asks and let it create the task list.
- 7 Open TASKS.md in the project folder and read the sections.
- 8 Add the follow-ups this course actually produced.
- 9 Run /productivity:update and see it triage.
- 10 Note what the plugin could also connect to.

Add the Productivity Plugin

✓ Check your work

The Productivity plugin appears under Your plugins, and typing / lists its /productivity: commands alongside the /daily-brief and /brand-deck skills you wrote. A TASKS.md file exists in the Meridian project folder with Active, Waiting On, Someday and Done sections, and it holds at least the three Meridian follow-ups: the Q4 Advisory target discrepancy, the board deck review, and the daily-brief draft check.

Recap — Claude Projects and Plugins

1

Lab 09

You can now assemble the data, instructions, skills and dashboard into one reusable Project.

2

Lab 10

You can now install a plugin and tell a packaged bundle apart from a skill you wrote yourself.

WRAP-UP

Summary & Next Steps

- 1 What you built
- 2 Staying in control
- 3 Next steps
- 4 Q&A

What You Achieved

1

Process documents

Set up the Cowork desktop workspace and have Claude process a folder of documents into a structured summary.

3

Connect Drive

Connect the Google Drive connector so Claude can read finance data held outside the chat.

5

Generate the board deck

Generate a board-ready deck with real charts from connected data, using a skill Claude loads on demand.

7

Brand it by command

Capture a documented house style as a reusable skill that brands any presentation on command.

9

Install a plugin

Install a plugin and explain how a packaged bundle of skills differs from a skill you wrote yourself.

2

Build a Live Artefact

Build, save and download a Live Artefact, including an interactive sales dashboard from supplied data.

4

Deliver by Gmail

Refresh a Live Artefact from connected data and send an approved summary with the Gmail connector.

6

Save it as a skill

Turn a verified routine into an Agent Skill with /skill-creator, update it, and explain a skill's three layers.

8

Build the Project

Assemble a Claude Project that holds the data, instructions, skills and dashboard as one reusable team workspace.

Staying in Control

Claude drafts and builds; you check and approve.

Work from mock data

Use the supplied synthetic Meridian data — never real client records in training.

Scope the connector

Give Claude one folder for the task, not your entire Drive.

Check every figure

Read the artefact's numbers back against the source file before you trust them.

Approve before sending

Read the drafted email in full; approve it only when the figures match.

Use a test recipient

Send class exercises to yourself, never to a real client.

Keep the original

Let Claude write new files; leave the source data untouched.

Next Steps

1

Rebuild it with your own data

Repeat Lab 2 using a real report you own, on a copy of the file.

2

Connect one source

Enable the connector for the place your finance data actually lives.

3

Automate one routine

Pick the thing you do every morning and capture it as a skill.

4

Start one Project

Give your main body of work a project folder, and let the context build.

5

Browse Discover

See what plugins already exist before you write a skill someone has packaged already.

THANK YOU FOR ATTENDING

Your Cowork toolkit is ready

A Live Artefact dashboard, two connected tools, a branded board deck, two skills of your own, the Project that holds them all and a plugin on top.